Uda approach briefing: 宇陀市森林組合 and the former 内牧 school site

Internal working note for Rob. Not for sending. Facts are sourced; items marked **unverified** need checking before use in any pitch. Nothing here implies a commitment by anyone.

1. Why this site

- The coop (宇陀市森林組合, 榛原桧牧1026) runs an office plus a **sawmill and wood-processing plant** on the former **内牧小学校** grounds. Residues = fuel; the heat-compression process (うだウッド) = a heat customer.
- Solid operator, per the city's audit (published 2026-03-27, data to FY2024): revenue ¥112.6M, surplus ¥3.0M; processing sales ¥50.1M (up from ¥30.2M); no serious audit findings. **Weak points:** 5 staff, members 1,164 (down from 1,361 in an old profile), capital ¥49.8M.
- Source: city audit PDF, docs/reference/uda_forest_coop_audit_R7_2026-03-27.pdf.

2. The site

- 内牧小学校 closed in 2006 (合併直後). Council 2024-03-22 (councillor 上田): the site was **leased free of charge** to the coop as its forestry base. So the land is probably city-owned. **Unverified:** current lease terms, term, and whether a sub-lease or new use needs city consent. Ask Uda 農林課 (0745-82-3679).
- Gate signs show the site is registered for combustibles (指定可燃物) storage: small permitting plus (unverified).
- Grid (Kansai T&D, 2026-10-27): 榛原 substation 77/6.6 kV: 4 MW own spare but **0 MW with upstream**, curtailment flag on. A 50 kWe prototype used on site is far below these limits; export beyond that needs a connection study. Which feeder serves the site is **unverified**.
- Hazard: hillside forest on all sides (landslide/flood maps not yet checked).

3. What the city has said (council minutes, research/uda_city DB)

- **Coops:** Uda has two (宇陀 and 室生村). 2024-03-22, 農林商工部長 東: the city will cooperate if both coops decide to restructure. Forest 18,273 ha, 13,931 ha plantation, more than half of owners hold under 5 ha.
- **Woody biomass:** 2021-06-21, councillor 八木 勝光 (still sitting, vice-chair 2026) urged woody-biomass power for Uda. Dept head: about **2,400 m3 a year** of Uda wood already goes to a biomass plant; the mayor saw merits but flagged haul and transport costs. 2024: the city was told it will "research domestic cases".
- **Data centers / IT:** 2024-03-22: a city plan to attract Estonian firms (Cleveron factory, **data centers**) was raised in council. Show interest, not a commitment.
- **Closed schools:** the city reuses them (旧野依小 became the new school lunch center, opened Sept 2024; 旧宇賀志小 became a fire station; 旧西谷小 and 旧田原小 are heading for private-sector reuse). Haibara's three elementary schools merge in April 2027; reuse of those sites is undecided (2026-06-23).

4. Your precedent

Safecast blog, Rob Oudendijk, 2012-12-19: around **Sept 2011** you and Yuka Hayashi were asked to help turn the old **Akazawa Elementary School** (Aizu-Misato) into a data center, for local jobs and learning; you were there until **1 Nov** (2011, inferred), built bGeigie loggers in the science room, and modified Ninja software to act as a

test device. Open points: Akazawa vs Yagisawa address, what "STP" is, whether it still operates. See docs/reference/aizu_school_data_center_reference.md.

5. Risks and unknowns

- Coop capacity (5 staff): the CHP and data center would need an outside operator.
- The Mitsue coop was keen on CHP but unsure about an AI data center; expect the same.
- Lease and city consent, grid upstream constraint, building condition (school-era structures; seismic), and heat/fuel quantities are all unquantified.
- Do not imply funding, contracts or approvals exist.

6. Next steps (in order)

1. Wait for the coop's reply (form + email sent 2026-10-29); phone 0745-82-1409 after 3-5 business days and confirm which email is right.
2. Call 農林課 on who owns the site and the lease terms; ask the 林業振興協力隊 contact.
3. Visit the coop (office, weekdays 8:30-17:30). Lead with heat and residue use; the data center as the second half.
4. Kansai T&D 事前相談 for the 榛原桧牧1026 address.
5. Muro coop: call for 山本 (boundary clarification); learn how owner and boundary data is built.
6. Confirm the Aizu facts with Rob, then cite.

日本語要約（社内メモ）

目的: 宇陀市森林組合（榛原桧牧1026）の旧内牧小学校跡地を、木質バイオマスCHPと小規模データセンターの試験地とする可能性の整理。確約・合意は一切ありません。

- **組合:** 製材・加工工場あり。令和6年度の事業収益1億1,263万円、剰余金約305万円、加工品販売5,010万円（前年3,016万円）。市の監査で重大な指摘なし。職員5名、組合員1,164名（旧資料は1,361名）。
- **跡地:** 内牧小学校は平成18年に廃校。令和6年3月22日の市議会で、組合へ**無償で貸与**されていると発言あり（現在の契約条件は未確認）。農林課（0745-82-3679）に所有・貸借の確認が必要。
- **市の姿勢:** 令和6年3月22日、農林商工部長は両森林組合（宇陀・室生村）の組織見直しがあれば市として協力すると答弁。令和3年6月21日、八木議員が木質バイオマス発電を提案、年約2,400立米が市外のバイオマス発電に搬出されていると答弁（コストが課題）。同年、エストニア企業・データセンター誘致の話題も議会で出ている。廃校の活用（旧野依小→給食センター等）に前向き。
- **系統:** 榛原変電所は上位系を考慮した空容量0MW。50kWe規模の自家消費なら問題は小さい見込み（供給元フィーダーは未確認）。
- **実績:** 2011年9月ごろ、会津美里町の旧赤沢小学校をデータセンターにする作業に参加（Safecastブログ、2012-12-19）。赤沢と八木沢の関係などは未確認。
- **次の手順:** 組合の返信待ち→電話確認→農林課へ跡地の所有・貸借を確認→訪問→関西電力送配電へ事前相談→室生村森林組合（山本氏）への聞き取り。